

ROCKING BACK

Playback singer Neha Bhasin, 27, is rewinding to her rocker days. The former Viva member is releasing her first solo album in May, which has a mix of hardcore rock and ballad numbers. Bhasin, who recently sang for the movie *Fashion*, turned to Bollywood after rock band Viva disbanded. Her collaboration with various American artists is part of her dream to head West. Let's hope the luck of A.R. Rahman and British Indian popstar Jay Sean rubs off on her too.



JAP WE MET

First came the foreign item girls, and now it's the turn of actors. Japanese actor **Chigusa Takaku** is the latest catch whose next to nil knowledge of English didn't stop her from impressing Aparna Sen who cast her in *The Japanese Wife—A Love Poem*. "Her sweet, vulnerable face was perfect for the role," says Sen. Will her performance be lost in translation? We hope not.

Miami Calling

Michelle Salins, 36, will be the newest Indian face at the Miami International Fashion Week. And the Bangalore-based designer couldn't be more thrilled: "When I got the invite, I just put back my head and thought, wow! It was a super feeling." Her collection titled *The Jewel Tones of India* has Indian colours, fabrics and embroidery on western silhouettes. She has even designed all the shoes. After all, she is following in the footsteps of Sabyasachi, Rina Dhaka and Manish Malhotra.



Chequered Kid

Chennai's **Aditya Patel** is the new young Turk of Indian motor racing. He will be a part of GREEN Racing in the VW SCIROCCO Cup this April, the world's only race car run on bio-gas. Bruce Lee fan Patel, 21, revels in the saloons because, "you can do crazy things".

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